

TSE ONLINE

E-Commerce Modernisation

Project Proposal & Engagement Agreement

Prepared by Ryno & Team

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1. Executive Summary

TSE Online is a well-established South African supplier of printer cartridges and related consumables. This proposal outlines a full digital modernisation of the TSE Online storefront — delivering a fast, professional, and conversion-optimised e-commerce experience built on proven open-source technology.

We are proposing a custom-built headless e-commerce platform that gives TSE Online full ownership of its codebase, zero platform licensing fees, and a suite of ongoing growth services — including automated social media marketing — for a predictable monthly retainer.

What You Get

- A fully custom Next.js + Medusa.js e-commerce storefront — no Shopify fees, no vendor lock-in
- A Cartridge Compatibility Wizard: customers select their printer model and are shown exact cartridge matches
- B2B customer portal with negotiated pricing tiers and bulk order / quote-request flows
- SA-native payments: PayFast, Ozow (Instant EFT), and card — the full stack SA shoppers expect
- Automated courier logic (Aramex, Courier Guy) with zone-based next-day delivery rules
- Instagram & Facebook automated posting bot — new and restocked products promoted automatically
- WhatsApp Business integration for order queries and cart recovery
- Full POPIA compliance: privacy policy, cookie consent, and data handling documentation

2. Scope of Work — Build Phase

The build phase delivers a production-ready e-commerce platform. Work is divided into five delivery milestones, each with a client review and sign-off gate.

Milestone 1 — Foundation & Design System

- Project scaffolding: Next.js 15 (App Router) + Medusa.js v2 monorepo
- Supabase PostgreSQL database provisioned and seeded with existing product catalogue
- Design system: Tailwind CSS + shadcn/ui, brand colours, typography (Inter), component library
- Cloudflare CDN configured with Johannesburg PoP for SA-optimal performance
- CI/CD pipeline: Vercel (frontend) + Railway (Medusa backend)

Milestone 2 — Core Commerce

- Product catalogue: brands, categories, variants, stock levels
- Cartridge Compatibility Wizard — printer model lookup to cartridge match
- Cart, checkout, and order management flows
- PayFast + Ozow payment gateway integration
- Zone-based shipping profiles (JHB/PTA next-day, national 2-3 day)

Milestone 3 — Customer Accounts & B2B Portal

- Customer registration, login, order history, saved addresses
- B2B customer groups with negotiated pricing tiers
- Bulk order flow with quote-request functionality
- Sanity CMS integration for owner-editable content (banners, about page, blog)

Milestone 4 — Marketing & Automation

- Instagram & Facebook Graph API integration for automated product posting
- n8n automation engine: post scheduler, caption generator (Claude API), image composer
- WhatsApp Business click-to-chat + cart abandonment recovery flow
- Transactional email via Resend (order confirmations, shipping updates, password reset)
- Klaviyo newsletter integration (optional, activated on retainer)

Milestone 5 — QA, Performance & Launch

- Cross-browser and mobile QA
- Core Web Vitals audit — target LCP < 2.5s, CLS < 0.1
- POPIA compliance audit and cookie consent banner
- Meiliseach product search — sub-50ms results
- Staff training session (owner content management via Sanity)
- Go-live and DNS cutover

3. Investment

3.1 One-Time Build Fee

The build fee covers everything from milestone 1 through go-live. Payment is structured across milestones to align cost with delivery.

Deliverable	Phase	Fee
Foundation, design system & DevOps	Milestone 1	Included
Core commerce (catalogue, cart, payments, shipping)	Milestone 2	Included
Customer accounts & B2B portal	Milestone 3	Included
Marketing automation & WhatsApp	Milestone 4	Included
QA, performance audit & launch	Milestone 5	Included
TOTAL BUILD INVESTMENT		R 18,000

Payment schedule: 40% on project kick-off (R7,200) · 30% at Milestone 3 sign-off (R5,400) · 30% on go-live (R5,400)

3.2 Monthly Growth Retainer

The retainer keeps the platform running, growing, and marketing itself. It includes all infrastructure costs — there are no hidden platform fees.

Service	Frequency	Approx. Cost
Infrastructure (Vercel Pro, Railway, Supabase, Resend, Cloudflare)	Monthly	~R 1,500
Marketing automation (Instagram/Facebook bot, content calendar)	Monthly	~R 3,500
Retained development hours (5–8 hrs: features, promotions, updates)	Monthly	~R 2,500
WhatsApp Business & analytics reporting	Monthly	~R 500
TOTAL MONTHLY RETAINER		~R 8,000

The retainer is invoiced monthly, 30 days in advance. A 3-month minimum commitment applies after go-live.

4. Technology Stack

The platform is built entirely on open-source and best-in-class SaaS tools. TSE Online owns the codebase outright — there are no platform licensing fees or revenue share arrangements.

Layer	Technology	Rationale
Frontend	Next.js 15 (App Router)	SEO, server components, SA-optimised performance
Commerce backend	Medusa.js v2	Open-source, no revenue share, full control
Database	Supabase (PostgreSQL)	Managed, scalable, real-time capable
Styling	Tailwind CSS + shadcn/ui	Fast build, polished, consistent components
CMS	Sanity (free tier)	Owner edits banners and blog without developer
Search	Meilisearch (self-hosted)	Sub-50ms, no usage fees
Frontend hosting	Vercel Pro	Global CDN, instant deploys
Backend hosting	Railway	Container hosting for Medusa + n8n
CDN & DNS	Cloudflare (JHB PoP)	SA latency optimised, DDoS protection, free
Payments	PayFast + Ozow	SA-native EFT, Instant EFT, and card
Email (transactional)	Resend	Reliable, cheap, developer-friendly
Automation engine	n8n	Visual workflow builder — social bots, alerts
Social API	Meta Graph API	Instagram + Facebook posting automation
AI (captions)	Anthropic Claude API	Product caption generation for social posts

5. Delivery Timeline

The full build targets an 8-week delivery from project kick-off to go-live, subject to timely client feedback at each milestone gate.

Period	Milestone	Theme	Key Deliverables
Week 1–2	Milestone 1	Foundation	Scaffolding, design system, DevOps, DB
Week 3–4	Milestone 2	Core Commerce	Catalogue, cart, payments, shipping
Week 5–6	Milestone 3	Accounts & B2B	Customer portal, B2B pricing, CMS
Week 7	Milestone 4	Marketing Automation	Instagram bot, WhatsApp, email flows
Week 8	Milestone 5	QA & Launch	Audit, performance, training, go-live

Client review windows are scheduled at the end of each milestone. A 3-business-day review window is required per gate to keep the project on schedule.

6. Terms & Conditions

6.1 Intellectual Property

Upon receipt of final payment, TSE Online receives full ownership of all custom code written for this project. Third-party libraries and frameworks remain subject to their respective open-source licences.

6.2 Retainer & Notice Period

The monthly retainer requires a minimum 3-month commitment post-launch. Thereafter, either party may terminate with 30 days written notice. Infrastructure credentials are transferred to the client on termination.

6.3 Scope Changes

Changes to the agreed build scope will be quoted separately and may affect the delivery timeline. Minor adjustments (content copy, colour tweaks) are accommodated at no extra charge within milestone review windows.

6.4 Client Responsibilities

- Provision of existing product data (CSV or spreadsheet export) within 3 business days of kick-off
- Brand assets: logo (SVG preferred), any existing photography, brand colour codes
- PayFast merchant account credentials for integration testing
- Meta Business account access for Instagram/Facebook bot setup

- Timely feedback within the 3-business-day review windows

6.5 Warranty

A 30-day post-launch warranty covers bugs and defects in delivered functionality at no charge. Issues arising from third-party service changes (Meta API, PayFast) or client-initiated content changes fall outside the warranty scope.

7. Proposal Acceptance

By signing below, both parties agree to the scope, investment, timeline, and terms described in this document.

CLIENT

SERVICE PROVIDER

Signature

Signature

Full Name

Full Name

Date

Date